



The role of sustainability in the Sri Lankan context

Introduction to Sustainability

Sustainability Development Goals



17 Goals

169 Targets

400+ Agencies

Status of Sri Lanka

OVERALL PERFORMANCE

COUNTRY
RANKING

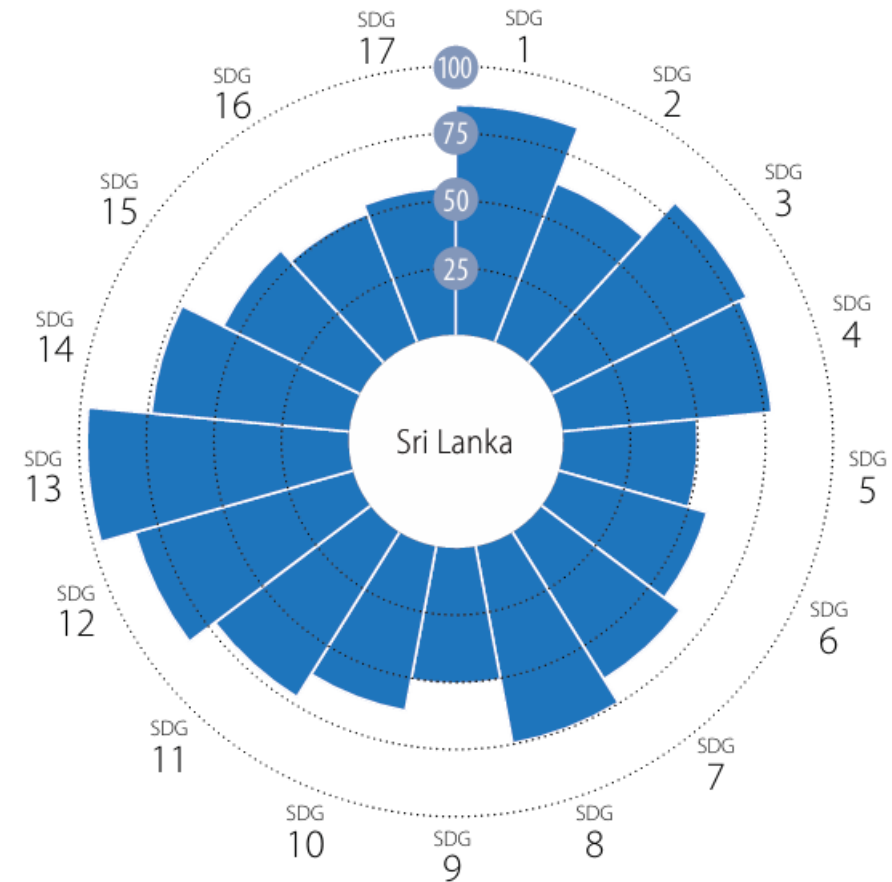
93/167

COUNTRY
SCORE



REGIONAL AVERAGE: 66.5

AVERAGE PERFORMANCE BY SDG



Status of Sri Lanka



Note: The full title of each SDG is available here: <https://sdgs.un.org>

Main sustainability development drive



Sri Lanka
Sustainable
Development
Act, No. 19 of
2017

Sustainable
Development
Council

- Secretary to the President
- Secretary to the Ministry of the Minister assigned the subject of Sustainable Development
- Secretary to the Ministry of the Minister assigned the subject of National Planning or his nominee
- Secretary to the Ministry of the Minister assigned the subject of Environment or his nominee;
- Eight other members appointed by the President

400+ Agencies

<http://sdc.gov.lk/en/agencies/19/12>

Sustainability Development policies

Based on the National Policy Framework (NPF) of the government, it has been identified Sustainable Environmental Management as one of the key element

It drives through “Achieving sustainable development through balanced social, economic and environmental practices”

The main objectives are as follows

- Environmental regulation for conservation and protection
- Updating the existing environmental policies , rules and regulations
- Integrating the SDGs into development framework
- Incorporating the indigenous knowledge and technologies into sustainable development
- Coordinating at all administrative levels to ensure upgrading living standards



Land

- Sustainable land-use in agriculture, animal husbandry and plantation
- Re-establish & enhance the green cover
- Introduce sophisticated technologies
- Control human impacts on marshy lands and mangroves
- Identify barren and abandoned lands
- Utilize them for agriculture and forestry

Waste Management



- Establish eco-industrial zones
- Raise awareness on waste generation and waste sorting
- Introduce sustainable consumption concepts from childhood
- Make waste sorting and separation in household and industry levels mandatory
- Develop an action plan to safeguard the ocean from pollution
- Establish shared sanitary landfills for local authorities
- Introducing incinerators for clinical and industrial waste disposal
- Identify illegal and irresponsible waste disposers and law enforcement

A conceptual image showing a man in a grey suit walking away from the viewer on a lush green field. In the background, a city skyline is visible, with a prominent blue skyscraper. Overlaid on the scene are various green energy and environmental symbols: a wind turbine, a solar panel, a factory with smokestacks, and stylized green clouds. The overall theme is sustainable development and green energy.

Atmosphere

- Plant trees, establish urban forests, green paths, green roofs and agroforestry systems
- Reduce fossil fuel consumption in transportation, industries and construction sectors

Ocean Resources

- Upgrade Ocean University on par with international standards
- Promote ocean exploration
- Ensure coastal erosion mitigation
- Promote off-shore sea sand for construction industry
- Issuing quality certificates for sieved and purified sea sands



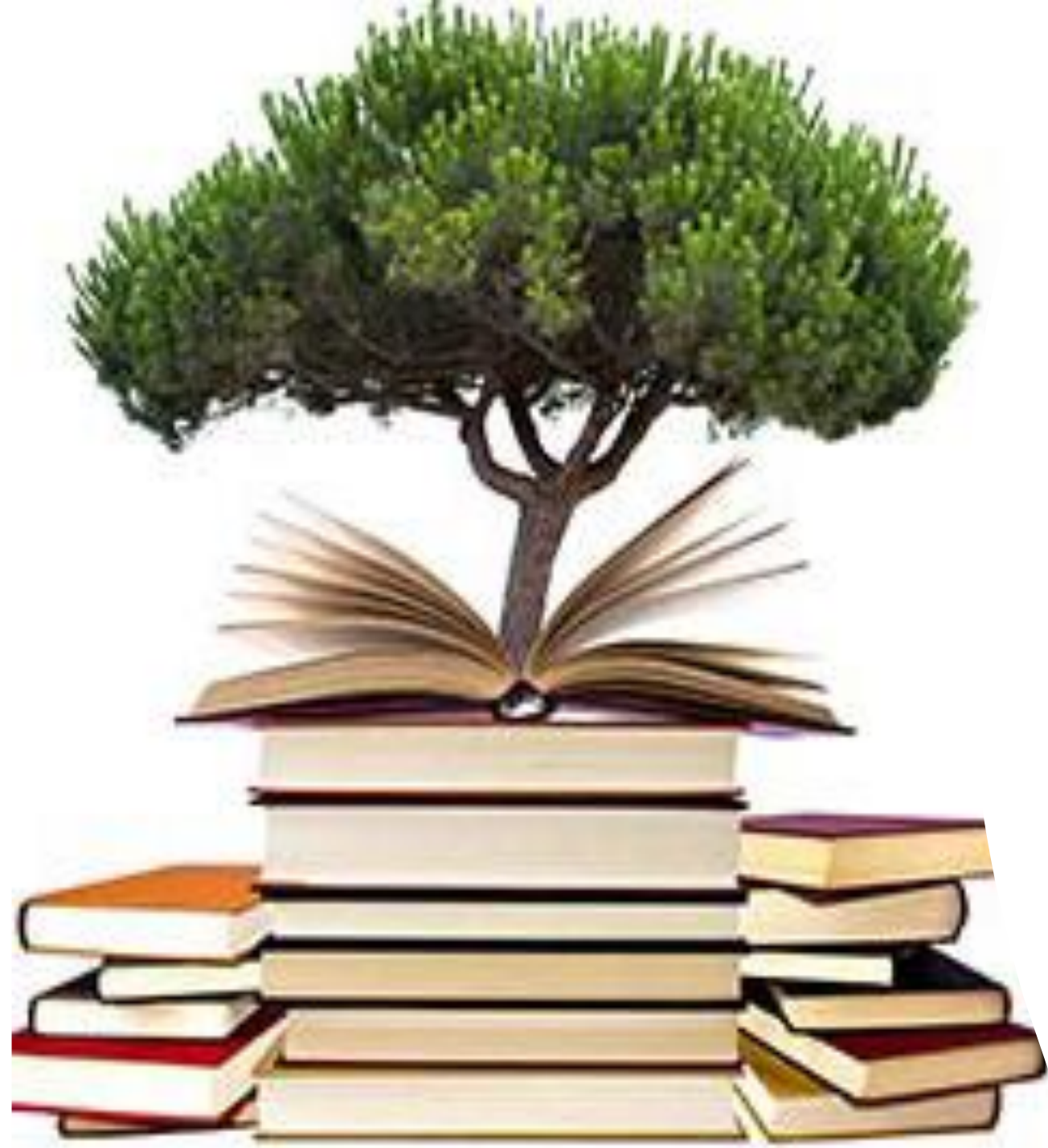


Settlements and cities

- Identify appropriate lands for development activities to minimize the environmental impacts
- Carry out Strategic Environmental Assessments (SEA) for each district
- Enforce Vertical Green Development for settlements
- Develop rural infrastructure resilient to natural disasters

Environmental Education

- Integrate environmental educational components into school curricular from grade 1 onwards.
- Promote awareness and positive attitude change.
- Develop targeted programmes for school children, youth and community to promote awareness and positive attitude change.





Sustainability Challenges in Sri Lanka

- **Poverty**

Poverty pockets exist throughout the country and disparities can be observed among districts

- **Health**

Population aging and increase of non-communicable diseases can be identified as challenges

- **Education**

Improving the quality and relevance of education, increasing access to higher and vocational education, standardizing non-state education remain as challenges



Sustainability Challenges in Sri Lanka

- **Gender equality**

Gender inequalities can be observed in labour force participation and political representation

- **Water and Sanitation**

Disparities exist among regions and there are issues on quality and quantity of drinking water. Providing facilities to the rest and wastewater in urban centers and industrial areas can be seen as challenges.

- **Energy**

Rising dependency on imports and cost of energy can be viewed as challenges.

Sustainability Challenges in Sri Lanka

- **Tourism**

A transformation in the tourism strategy is needed for its sustainability.

- **Natural resources**

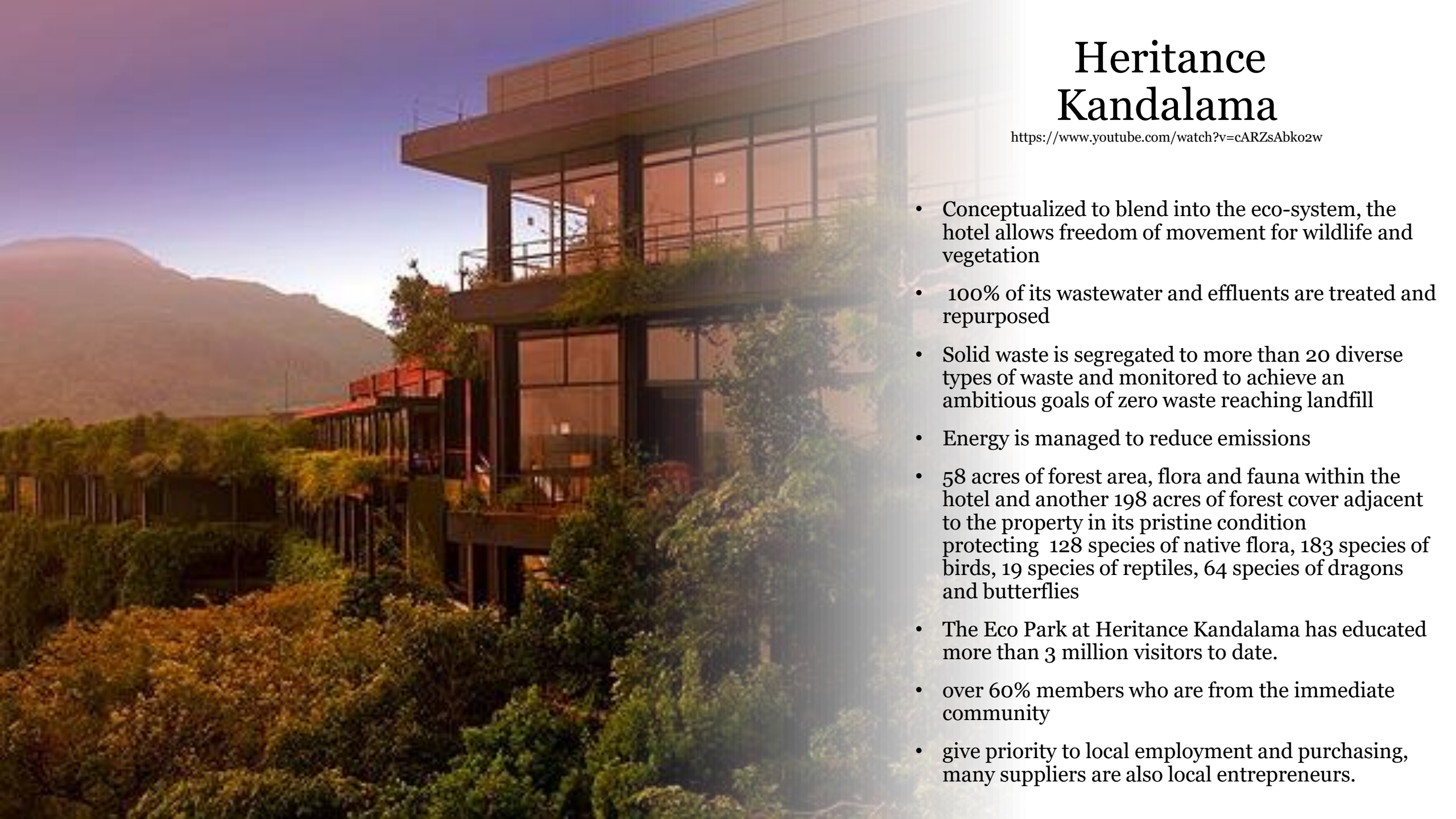
A considerable number of species are threatened species. Deforestation has become and challenge due to increased demand for land

- **Peace**

The government seeks to build a peaceful, reconciled and prosperous Sri Lanka based on a three-pillar strategy of strengthening democracy, reconciliation and economic development, with the participation of all stakeholders, as reflected in the Peace building Priority Plan

<https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=cARZsAbko2w>



A photograph of the Heritage Kandalama hotel, a modern multi-story building with large glass windows and balconies, built into a lush, green hillside. The building is surrounded by dense tropical vegetation, and a mountain range is visible in the background under a clear sky.

Heritage Kandalama

<https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=cARZsAbko2w>

- Conceptualized to blend into the eco-system, the hotel allows freedom of movement for wildlife and vegetation
- 100% of its wastewater and effluents are treated and repurposed
- Solid waste is segregated to more than 20 diverse types of waste and monitored to achieve an ambitious goals of zero waste reaching landfill
- Energy is managed to reduce emissions
- 58 acres of forest area, flora and fauna within the hotel and another 198 acres of forest cover adjacent to the property in its pristine condition protecting 128 species of native flora, 183 species of birds, 19 species of reptiles, 64 species of dragons and butterflies
- The Eco Park at Heritage Kandalama has educated more than 3 million visitors to date.
- over 60% members who are from the immediate community
- give priority to local employment and purchasing, many suppliers are also local entrepreneurs.